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VENTURE CAPITAL

Uzbekistan's 1st unicorn Uzum takes victory lap with \$70M at \$1.5B valuation

By [Leah Hodgson](#)

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Uzbek ecommerce unicorn [Uzum](#) has raised \$70 million from China's [Tencent](#) and US-based VR Capital, boosting its valuation by 25% to \$1.5 billion.

This latest round follows a \$114 million Series A last year, which made it [Uzbekistan’s first unicorn](#) at a \$1.2 billion valuation. At its previous raise, Uzum was already targeting \$200 million for a Series B.

Existing investor [FinSight Ventures](#), which led Uzum’s Series A, also participated in the latest round.

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Founded in 2022, Uzum’s ecosystem includes an online marketplace, express delivery service, digital banking and a lending service. Over half of Uzbekistan’s population, about 17 million people, use its services monthly. For FY2024, the company reported \$150 million in net income, up 50% year-over-year.

Uzum is not only Uzbekistan’s first unicorn, but also the only VC-backed company in Central Asia with a valuation exceeding \$1 billion, according to PitchBook data. Only a few VC deals are made in the region each year, but its market is growing.

This year, \$86.8 million has been invested across 12 deals, which, at the current pace, would put Central Asia on track to surpass last year’s record \$144.9 million in deal value.

According to a KPMG [report](#), Central Asia is emerging as a hotspot for global VC investors due to its young, tech-savvy population and fast-growing economies such as Kazakhstan. More startups with international-focused business models and local VC funds are emerging to boost the ecosystem’s growth.

Featured image by abalcazar/Getty Images

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About [Leah Hodgson](#)

Leah Hodgson is a London-based senior reporter for PitchBook, covering the venture capital ecosystem across Europe and the Middle East. Leah, who joined PitchBook in 2018, graduated from the University of Surrey with a BA in international politics with French. She has previously been a radio reporter in France. She later turned to financial journalism, covering the wealth management industry.

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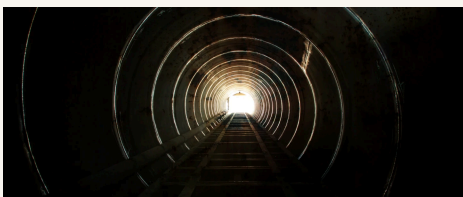
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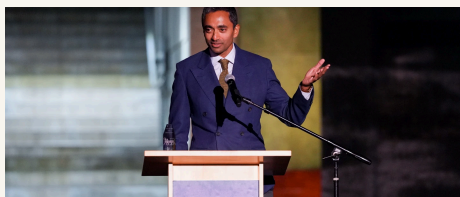


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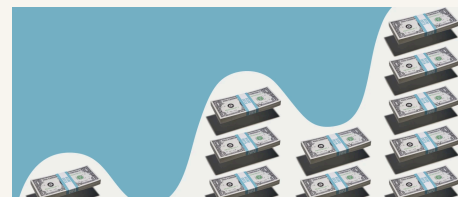


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